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Country: Afghanistan

Initiation Plan

Project Title:	Strengthening Community Safety Well-being and Human Security in Afghanistan
Expected CPD Outcome:	Outcome 3: Economic growth is accelerated to reduce vulnerabilities and poverty, strengthen the resilience of the licit economy and reduce the illicit economy in its multiple dimensions
Expected UNTEF Outcomes:	Outcome 2: By the end of 2022, essential services are sustained that address basic human needs for the people in Afghanistan Outcome 3: By the end of 2022, Afghanistan will preserve social investments and community-level systems essential to meeting basic human needs, protect gains to the SDGs, and develop scenarios for future engagement
Initiation Plan Start/End Dates:	1 June 2022 - 31 March 2023
Implementing Agency:	United Nations Development Programme

Brief Description

The unspent balance of $53,247,792 from JSB (Japanese Supplementary Budget) 2020 for LOTFA (Law and Order Trust Fund for Afghanistan) has been repurposed for the "Strengthening Community Safety Well-being and Human Security in Afghanistan" Initiation Plan. While maintaining LOTFA's original objective (i.e., supporting law and order initiatives), this project has adjusted the previously planned outputs and activities to the current operating environment in Afghanistan. In terms of objectives and outputs, this project aims to address the needs of the groups vulnerable to violence and crime while the project funded through JSB 2021 aims to respond to the vulnerable groups in general.

Programme Period:	1 June 2022 – 31 March 2023
Atlas Project Number:	_____
Atlas Output ID:	_____
Gender Marker:	GEN 2

Total resources required	$53,247,792
Total allocated resources:	$53,247,792
• Other:	
○ Donor	Japan

Agreed by UNDP:

Abdallah Al Dardari
Resident Representative
UNDP Afghanistan

Signature **Date**

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I. BACKGROUND

Afghanistan is currently experiencing crises on multiple fronts, all at the same time. A combination of a suspension of foreign aid, the freezing of Afghan government assets, and international sanctions on the Taliban as well as the near collapse of basic service delivery and formal banking systems, have plunged a country already suffering from high poverty levels into a full-blown economic crisis, amplified by the prolonging pandemic. According to the UNDP's Socio-Economic Outlook study published in December 2021,[1] the current macroeconomic situation may lead to a 10-13 percent reduction in GDP (gross domestic product) that could, in the worst-case scenario, bring Afghanistan to the near universal poverty – a 97 percent poverty rate by mid-2022 - despite the difficult but real progress achieved over the last 20 years.

These deteriorating socio-economic conditions have been increasingly undermining the community's self-reliance and aggravating the drivers of violence, crime, instability, and displacement. Tensions arising from access to resources, food insecurity, unemployment, widespread poverty, limited or restricted access to essential services, including girls' education, and existing ethnic and tribal divisions could further lead to fragility and civil unrest. Scarcer water and arable land may increase community-level and inter-ethnic conflicts. From this perspective, saving livelihoods is critical, but the prevention of potential conflict through livelihood stabilization is also equally important. Efforts on both fronts need to go side by side with the urgent efforts to save lives through humanitarian aid and emergency relief.

With the limited opportunities for education and jobs as well as community participation and social integration, Afghans, especially youth, are now more exposed to risks of violence and engagement in criminal and unlawful activities. Violent extremists could establish a strong base in poorly served areas, as they feel neglected by their government and international communities and turn to extremist groups for help. Given that the security system under the de facto authorities (DFA) is not fully functional, it will be important to strengthen the community's self-reliance by stabilizing their livelihoods, which will help prevent people from adopting negative coping strategies.

The political changes in August 2021 have also significantly disrupted education for children as well as youth, in addition to the COVID-19-prompted measures. According to the latest UNICEF data, 4.2 million children remain out of school at least 60 per cent of whom are girls. The morale and teacher attendance were reportedly low because of frequent delays in payment of teacher salaries and leakage. In response, the European Union (EU) has decided to provide €50 million for emergency cash support to the around 194,000 public teachers nationwide with around €90 per month for two months during the harsh wintertime. Furthermore, the discussions are also underway to provide follow-up support through the Afghanistan Reconstruction Trust Fund (ARTF). To ensure an appropriate financial support for public teachers will continue to be an important area in terms of protecting the safety of adolescent youth and children and strengthening the community's self-reliance. The cost of education per child has increased from $81 to $108 in 2022. The current situation is unclear as the humanitarian response rapid appraisal has reported a complete breakdown of the education information management system (EMIS) data. The data normally included in the EMIS include data on student enrolment attendance, teacher

[1] https://www.undp.org/publications/afghanistan-socio-economic-outlook-2021-2022-averting-basic-needs-crisis#modal-publication-download

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recruitment and attendance, the status of facilities, the status of schools etc. The public education system employs approximately 187,000 teachers (including 35% women), while NGO-implemented community-based education aims to employ approximately 15,000 teachers. The humanitarian response for 2022 will focus on the provision of emergency education services and investments for acutely vulnerable children who would not otherwise have access to education. About 22,174 public school teachers working in areas where children have acute humanitarian needs, will be supported with incentives. This represents 12 per cent of all teachers in Afghanistan.

The project will ensure gender-responsive (GS) and conflict- sensitive (CS) approaches to all its initiatives. For Afghan women and girls, gains made in the past 20 years are being threatened under the Taliban rule. Afghanistan ranks among the least favourable on the Gender Inequality Index[2] and the gap in inequality is most likely to widen further under the current *de facto* authorities. On average, Afghan women earn 16 percent less than men, and women in Afghanistan are outnumbered 5 to 1 by men in sectors that require higher skills[3] . This may be influenced by the lower female literacy rate at 53 percent, compared to the worldwide average of 79 percent[4]. As of September 2021, it was estimated that nearly 87 percent of Afghan women had experienced at least one form of gender-based violence and 62 percent had experienced all three forms of GBV: psychological, physical, and sexual. Data gaps[5] in key areas such as the gender pay gap and unpaid and domestic work remain[6], but the project's investment in women's economic empowerment and livelihoods is critical to safeguard development gains and opportunities for women in Afghanistan.

Given the context of Afghanistan, Community Security (CS) should be understood as a way of promoting a community-driven approach to understanding and improving the relationships between and behaviours of communities, authorities and institutions. As the *de facto* authorities have not been recognised by the international community, this particular intervention will work with local communities using participatory assessments and planning methods and will seek to contribute to a full range of security and development improvements identified by the communities themselves. The objective is to set up a process that leads to better service delivery, reduced social exclusion, reduced radicalization, enhanced relations between social groups, and improved information sharing related to matters pertinent to their security. Communities are confronted with fear and intimidation because of the lack and/or limited access to security and justice services and trust and confidence in the de facto authorities remain difficult. Communities are still self-reliant in monitoring and supporting safety and security needs at the local level with the help of community elders and leaders. The is a marked increase in crime and robberies reported in the recent months which is a result of lack of income and security and justice services. The absence of an active war does not guarantee enhanced community security. The post-August events, lack of economic opportunities including formal-sector work for people and the COVID-19 pandemic, have further exacerbated security and eroded community-level safety. Security and poverty have affected the most vulnerable families and their children. For a long time, stereotypical social norms have restricted the number of secondary school girls that were able to attend school.

2 https://www.unicef.org/afghanistan/gender-focus

3 www.afghan-analysts.org

4 www.afghan-analysts.org

5 Refugees International: Afghan Women and Girls Under Immediate Threat: The Responsibility to Protect and Assist Is Just Beginning, Oct 2021.

6 https://data.unwomen.org/country/afghanistan

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II. Strategy

If Afghan communities, including youth and women, can be lead agents in the creation of alternative economic opportunities and prospects to safeguard their livelihoods as well as the protection of adolescent youth and children from negative influence of crime and violence, then communities' self-reliance will be enhanced, thereby contributing to improving the community security, well-being and safety in the country.

Building on its past initiatives and the existing expertise and delivery capacity, UNDP aims to achieve the objective of the project through outputs: (i) enhancing community-led and community-owned economic opportunities and employment prospects; and (ii) supporting the payment of teachers' stipends to safeguard adolescent youth and children from negative influence of crime and violence. (iii) community safety and security strengthened through community engagement and empowerment to build trust and confidence

In terms of the first output, security at the community level is linked to a number of interventions that must take into consideration aspects such as participation, ownership as well as opportunities for dignified lives including access to income generation opportunities, jobs, health and education, with adequate COVID-19 preventive measures across the board. Employment is particularly relevant in the current context as the post-August 15th shift has resulted in severe economic instability across multiple channels, adding yet another challenge for communities and vulnerable segments of the population – including women, youth, and IDPs – alike. Lack of livelihood opportunities has exacerbated the current security situation, as people could be forced to take desperate measures to get by. There are significant differences in the level of unemployment, female labour force participation, labour underutilization and youth unemployment between the provinces. Provinces with a high rate of youth unemployment are of great concern as without jobs, the youth are either likely to migrate or become involved in the illicit economy and may pose a significant conflict risk[7] and thus investing in livelihoods at this moment also means investing in preventing violent extremism. UNDP has been at the forefront of cash-for-work (CfW) efforts even in the current context, increasing its activities on the ground to promote economic security and allow communities to rebuild their social and economic fabrics from within through economic inclusion.

The second output is linked to the safety of adolescent youth, children, teachers, and poverty reduction. UNDP played a key role in managing salary payments for the security sector (LOTFA) prior to the political changes last year (2021). With the support of the Global Fund, UNDP has also transferred salaries to over 24,000 health workers under the Sehatmandi project. These experiences will be leveraged to reinforce UNICEF's teacher stipend payment initiative. At the same time, the scope and nature of UNDP's support in this area will be determined in consultation with the Government of Japan and in coordination with UNICEF and the requirements of the Afghanistan Reconstruction Trust Fund's (ARTF). In many schools, the rooms are not properly ventilated, and no pandemic prevention measures have been taken. School children are generally not aware of COVID-19 social distancing rules and in some schools, the water and sanitation facilities are not working so that hand washing is difficult. UNICEF reported that poor hygiene and sanitation conditions contribute to the spread of COVID-19, diarrhea, fever, and vomiting diseases among children, which affects their studies and school attendance.

[7] ABADEI Strategy, pp-17

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This component will therefore need to be supplemented with COVID-19 awareness training for school children, teachers, and community members, and will include the procurement of COVID-19 PPE (personal protection equipment) such as masks, sanitizers and handwashing facilities.

The third output aims to revive community-led safety and security actions designed to reduce crime and violence, enhance community security and human mobility and to reduce radicalization at the provincial and district levels. Fear and intimidation remain high at the community level, particularly for women and youth in remote villages and districts where security and justice services are weak or non-existent. As community policing practices are not a viable option under the de facto authorities (DFA), communities led by tribal elders and leaders are resorting to set up and share information on risks and threats using informal safety and security measures. In Afghanistan, there are some CSOs that have some experience in establishing dispute resolution committees and developing community security plans, such as ~~APA (Afghan Planning Agency)~~ AIRO (Afghanistan Independent Rehabilitation Organization). In collaboration with these CSOs/NGOs as implementing partners, and using the existing community structure, such as the "Shura (council)", the project could hold community consultations and develop security plans to deal with problems such as crime, the radicalization of the youth, and sexual violence.

Please refer annex: TOC

III. Results and Partnerships

The present crisis in Afghanistan poses numerous challenges to human and economic security for the general population and is particularly hard for the vulnerable groups, including women and the youth. From the perspective of both protection and empowerment, this project aims *to support economic security and well-being through a community-based approach, focusing on socio economic interventions including essential infrastructure, services safety, and inclusive livelihoods as well as primary and secondary education support, in addition to simultaneously providing COVID-19 preventative assistance.*

The proposed objective(s) will be achieved with the following outputs through activities and actions under Key Pillars below[8]:

1. PROVISION OF ESSENTIAL SERVICES AND BASIC INFRASTRUCTURE
2. COMMUNITY-BASED LIVELIHOODS AND LOCAL ECONOMIES
3. SOCIAL COHESION AND INCLUSIVE, PARTICIPATORY PROCESSES

OUTPUT 1: COMMUNITY-LED AND COMMUNITY-OWNED LIVELIHOODS OPPORTUNITIES ENHANCED TO PREVENT PEOPLE FROM ADOPTING NEGATIVE COPING STRATEGIES.

Activity 1.1:
Identification of active Micro and Medium-Sized Enterprises (40 SMEs and 1000 Micro) and provision of financial and technical support aimed at business continuation and the opening of

[8] Refer ABADEI Strategy

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smaller production facilities in high poverty areas to create employment opportunities for at-risk population groups.

Activity 1.2:
Identification and solarization of production facilities of 60 selected SMEs

Activity 1.3:
Identification of communities and provision of financial and technical support to assist with the identification of local needs and the creation of 40 social enterprises in areas such as food security, health, renewable energy, waste management, clean water access, and education.

Activity 1.4:
Identification of local level needs and creation of income generation opportunities through Cash for Work (CFW) schemes aimed at building, rehabilitating, managing and maintaining small productive infrastructure linked to food security, water access, transport and market linkages, and energy.

Description of activities
The Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) can be important stakeholders to generate employment opportunities in high-poverty areas in Afghanistan and can be leveraged to improve the local employment prospects and thus help curb the incentive to attract, especially the youth to undesirable means of survival such as violent extremism, crime, trafficking and illicit drugs' business.

Activity 1.1 will mainly support existing livelihoods and businesses to remain operational and develop small production facilities and workshops in new locations, resulting in better and wider employment prospects for youth and other at-risk population groups. The activity will support the selected businesses (MSMEs) through a combination of options as per the need – financial support for the purchase of equipment needed for their expansion according to their trade, business training, etc. The beneficiary enterprises would match the UNDP support by covering the other business expansion-related expenditures, including rent, land purchase for the new facility, training of newly hired staff and other necessary inputs. The matching mechanism will ensure ownership, transparency and sustainability for the participating enterprises, and proper income analysis to appropriately determine salaries and grants to avoid unintended negative consequences in the local economies.

Activity 1.2, the provision of clean, affordable, and reliable electricity through stand-alone solar energy systems to the selected MSMEs to ensure sustained economic growth and development.

Activity 1.3 aims at complementing activity 1.1 by building broader community ownership, participation, and economic inclusion options through support to community-led micro-businesses as well as community-owned productive infrastructure to facilitate the provision of products and services for existing MSMEs, or to develop local solutions for the provision of services and products addressing local needs. Community-led social enterprises will create a safe space for different groups – including women, youth, the disabled, IDPs and others – to come together, identify local needs in areas such as food security, education, clean water access, renewable energy and waste management and create community-led micro-businesses for the purpose. In so doing, they will be creating livelihoods for the

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marginalized segments of the population that are most at risk of violence – either as victims or perpetrators and with a focus on youth – helping to contribute to stronger social cohesion and resilience locally. For those community-led social enterprises focusing on serving other MSMEs, UNDP will help identify markets in order to support communities to develop business models aimed at responding to existing demands. In addition to this, UNDP will support solutions mapping exercises to identify potential scale -up of initiatives with the capacity to mitigate market failures or gaps in supply.

Activity 1.4 will offer temporary employment opportunities, targeting men, women and youth. By involving them in the building, rehabilitation, management and maintenance of community-owned productive infrastructure, this intervention will provide an alternative to violence, which has been exacerbated by the current economic crisis. Through consultations with community members at large to identify common needs, UNDP will offer Cash for Work (CfW) employment opportunities to address infrastructure needs that can help improve aspects such as food security (product sorting, processing, storage), water access for different purposes, transportation to enhance market linkages as well as energy provision through appropriate systems. This activity will continue creating employment even beyond completion, as infrastructure management and maintenance will be promoted throughout the same, and technical skills provided to ensure sustainability and correct usage. Cash for Work initiatives will be linked to Activities 1.1 and 1.2 so, temporary employment will ideally engage participants with existing MSMEs, community-owned businesses and value chains.

Output 2 Adolescent youth and children safeguarded from negative influence of crime and violence through the payment of teachers' stipends

Activity 2.1:
Determine the scope and nature of the payment for teachers' stipend in coordination with UNICEF

Activity 2.2:
Provide one-month stipend to target public teachers through UNICEF (For the planning purpose, 194,000 public teachers targeted under the EU's funding for UNICEF will be used with $100 as a stipend for one month.)

Activity 2.3:
Ensure with UNICEF that payments are verified through a third-party monitor

Activity 2.4:
Conduct awareness and provide medical supplies for COVID prevention to 60 schools

Description of Activities
Traditionally, public teachers' salaries came from the Afghan government's Ministry of Education, funded fully by the World Bank's Afghanistan Reconstruction Trust Fund (ARTF). Following the political changes last August, the World Bank's funding to Afghanistan, including the ARTF, has ceased, resulting in the suspension or unstable payment of teachers' salaries, but with EU support, UNICEF has resumed the stipend payment for the primary and secondary public- school teachers across the country for two months.

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In consultation with the Government of Japan and in coordination with UNICEF, UNDP will support a one-month stipend payment for public primary and secondary teachers through the UN- to- UN Transfer Agreement modality.

UNDP will leverage its experience with the Sehatmandi project where payments were made to health workers through Money Service Providers (MSPs) in delivering this output. UNDP's experience with the use of a third-party monitor from the LOTFA payroll regime to complement its assurance responsibility[9] will also be relevant in working with UNICEF for the verification of payments. UNICEF will use a mix of UNICEF direct supervision, contracted Technical Extenders (TEs), and a contracted Third -Party Monitoring (TPM) company to monitor payments and will also establish direct verification mechanisms, using bulk phone/SMS message flows to reach out directly to teachers/staff and ask if they received their payment.

Output 3: Community safety and security strengthened through community engagement and empowerment to build trust and confidence

Activity 3.1:
Provide grants to CSOs to formulate community-led plans and initiatives for community security monitoring, reporting and early response.

Activity3.2:
Support communities, networks particularly women and youth to disrupt processes of radicalization and promote rights-based narratives, tolerance and respect for diversity using online/virtual tools and off-line social dialogues

Description of activities

The lack of a formal police, judiciary and security and prevailing fear and intimidation had led to a breakdown of the security and justice context, resulting in increased pressure on communities and their leaders. In this context, it is critical to improve human security alongside livelihood to strengthen security and safety through sustained community engagement and participation, and by empowering each household and community to identify and mitigate conflict when it arises. Local mediators within the local shuras like the mullahs, tribal elders and leaders will be supported so that they can nurture and reinforce citizen engagement to disrupt the processes of radicalization and exclusion and prevent an increase in violence and crime. The activities will target women and youth using popular media and locally developed and tailored initiatives to prevent their recruitment and radicalization.

A community approach, focused on multi-stakeholder dialogue will be used to develop a safety/security plan to resolve security issues identified by citizens. It will provide an opportunity for them to respond and resolve these issues and link them to broader social and economic initiatives by reviving women

[9] In a fragile environment like Afghanistan, fraud, ghost workers, etc. can be a course for concern. Staff absenteeism can also be high as a result of physical displacement caused by fighting, degraded or destroyed infrastructure, and recalcitrant behaviours. Noting that such issues could have grave effects on the delivery of education to the students, UNDP considers engaging the services of a local third-party firm or verifier, to provide assurance over the payroll and personnel database integrity, identify ghost workers, data gaps, or duplications, and report on control weaknesses. As a basic safeguard against inadvertently paying teachers who did not work, time and attendance sheets will be integrated into the payroll systems. This is a key lesson learned from the LOTFA payroll operation.

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and youth shuras for safety and security to prevent, monitor and respond to issues. The objective is to reduce conflict, build trust and confidence, share information to improve human security by helping to develop more resilient and safer communities. The initiative will provide basic safety tools and equipment's along with setting up of online platforms for monitoring, communication, and information sharing.

The initiatives will engage with the communities to: (1) support CSOs to lead the development of community security plans and responses/needs and (2) strengthen capacities for monitoring, early warning and responses that proactively forecast simmering tensions before they escalate into violent conflicts using networks, positive and human rights-based narratives and tolerance

UNDP will coordinate all activities in this project with other UN agencies, including UNICEF, to avoid duplications and promote synergies and complementarities. UNDP will engage communities and local CSOs in the selected areas of intervention for the provision of training, support and monitoring and evaluation functions. UNDP will also work with legal aid networks, faith-based networks, women's organizations, and financial entities in implementing this project. UNDP will use its roster to work with registered NGOs and CSOs that have been vetted in terms of financial, programmatic, and operational accountability. In order to adequately address financial issues and mitigate certain aspects of credit risk, UNDP also carries out the Harmonized Approach to Cash Transfers (HACT) for registered civil society

Resources required:
Project implementation will be reliant on the following human resources, grant funds and technical services:

- **Project staff**: will include one Project Manager (P5): the overall coordinator/project manager and a finance officer, Project Coordination Specialist, National Coordinator, Finance Analyst, and Programme Associate. The project will also be supported by ABADEI Programme Management Team, including its Programme Officer, on a cost-sharing basis.
- **Local authorities**: the project will inform the local authorities in Southeast, Central, Northeast and Southern provinces in order to deliver the project's intended outcomes.
- **Responsible Parties:** UNDP will engage vetted "Responsible Parties" (RPs) in order to help ensure the implementation of specific project activities, and the Development Effectiveness Unit (DEU) will provide technical advice.
- **UNDP Afghanistan programme staff:** the Peace, Prosperity, and Sustainability Pillars and other supporting units like procurement, security, human resources, finance, and management support in UNDP's Afghanistan Country office will support the project in the areas of resource mobilisation, quality assurance, technical guidance, and policy advocacy efforts undertaken by the central government and the broader development community. All UNDP Afghanistan staff time devoted to implementing the project has been accounted for in the Direct Project Costs (DPC) incorporated into the project budget calculations.
- **GPN/RBAP/:** the project will work closely with and obtain technical and strategic support from Global Policy Network (GPN)/ Regional Bureau for Asia and the Pacific (RBAP).

PARTNERSHIPS: UNDP interventions in all four areas will promote local partnership, including peace and security, livelihoods, essential services, at the community level and bolster social cohesion by ensuring inclusive community based participatory process towards local consultations, conflict prevention,

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identification of community-led solutions and provision of psychosocial support. To this end, UNDP will use a staggered approach by working with local elders, male mahram, and religious leaders in order to assess the situation and, later on, make improvements towards enhancing women's participation within the current social and political context in Afghanistan.

- ✓ Targeting vulnerable women and youth in the region will focus on regeneration of incomes, reconciliation, reinforcing collective decision making and consensus building engaging the different local actors formal and informal leadership to identify the socio-economic resilience and recovery plans.
- ✓ Reinforce partnership with the local networks, peace committees and civil society organizations in supporting multistakeholder platforms and local mechanisms for dialogue and conflict resolution, sustain peace, mediation to promote positive social norms and attitudes including eliminating violence against women and girls.
- ✓ Engage with local actors (formal and informal) and local leadership involving religious/tribal/traditional/elders in the community to ensure inclusive, equitable and transparent access to services for all communities. The community based participatory consultations will include women, men and representation from other marginalized groups. Currently women have been severely affected and their movements have been restricted just within the household, thus alternative forms of participation and livelihood will be focused on the community response plans.
- ✓ Engage with specialist UN agencies and experts to create initial, and regularly updated situational and risk assessments, and build appropriate delivery strategies based on those assessments. Recognizing the need (i) to manage the range of risks of programming in this context; and (ii) to ensure effective, adaptive approaches that reflect the social and political dynamics, UNDP anticipates to collaborate and coordinate with WFP, UNHCR and FAO in the target locations to maximise the project's impact and work closely at the sub-cluster level with Food Security and Agriculture and Protection.
- ✓ Promote partnership with local stakeholders providing services including cash transfers to individuals, communities and CSOs for the direct implementation of projects where NGOs or other local partners are not present or are unable to deliver aid due to current conditions.
- ✓ UNDP will partner with ILO and UNHCR on developing a harmonised approach to addressing immediate economic insecurities, including through access to emergency employment and incomes and contribute to cross-border programming to support IDPs in Afghanistan and refugees in Iran and Pakistan. UNDP wil partner with UN Women to coordinate help to women and girls affected by GBV.

Implementation of these activities will be at the sub-national level: provincial, district and community levels This will allow the UNDP and partners to work directly with community organizations, local NGOs, local Afghan institutions, and the private sector in identifying needs, delivering assistance and strengthening local service delivery. A 'bottom-up' and 'local first' approach to addressing needs, strengthening resilience, and tackling structural drivers of vulnerability and conflict will be used in the first phases of a transition period while national institutions are (re)established.

STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT

In the stakeholder engagement, accountability channels will be established for the reporting of any unfair exclusion or selection of beneficiaries. The project will target unemployed youth, women, socially excluded and other marginalized groups, including IDPs, returnees and host communities, households

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with the highest levels of food insecurity and malnutrition, and women-headed households, as well as people with disabilities and minority groups. Further, as to the partnership approach described under section 3.3, the project's implementation will be participatory and overseen by a Project Board. At the outset, the project will promote ownership by the targeted local communities and civil society organizations. The proposed intervention will target Southeast, Northeast Central and Southern provinces. The selection of target groups will be governed by the severity of incidences, the number of returnees, number of IDPs, People in Need, an overall Humanitarian Needs Overview (HNO), and the experience of UNDP and other UN agencies and previous JSB's intervention. Similar vulnerability-scoring criteria will be developed for targeting beneficiaries.

- **Vulnerable Groups**: Various vulnerable groups, such as widows, pregnant women, lactating mothers, persons with disabilities, domestic violence victims, refugees, orphans, street children, the elderly, the unemployed, the homeless, nomads, IDPs, returnees, youths/women, the marginalized, children, forcibly married young girls, malnourished people, and those who are ill or immuno-compromised are particularly vulnerable when a disaster or a health crisis strikes. Therefore, vulnerable households/individuals will be selected through a consultative and inclusive participatory process, using beneficiary selection criteria jointly developed by partners.
- **Youth:** The project will give special attention to youth, including young women – as an essential driver of peace, providing them with avenues for earning income and achieving economic participation through micro-business opportunities.
- **Women**: The chaos connected with, and the mental stress generated by, the crisis, coupled with entrenched gender inequality, have left women and girls particularly vulnerable to violence, abuse and exploitation. The proposed project would promote increasing women's role in community decision-making, enhancing women's access to non-traditional jobs, and elevating women's role in business whilst implementing cross-cutting gender perspectives within market value chains. Throughout existing local community committees, women will be included in project design(s), implementation, and monitoring and evaluation (M&E) to ensure they have access to the benefits they value and the capacity to manage the resource base sustainably.
- **Internally displaced people and returnees:** Livelihood opportunities and access to essential services are among the top two priority needs for IDPs and returnees; the project will address this challenge by providing employment and skill development opportunities for displaced beneficiaries.
- **Relevant local stakeholders and agencies:** The project is intended to work closely with local authorities and cooperatives to strengthen the livelihood-related training. At the same time, engaging men and faith-based networks in the effort to promote gender equality and social cohesion.
- **Microfinance Institutions (MFIs), civil society organizations, SMSEs, banks and private sectors**: The project will develop partnerships with MFIs, banks, private sector actors, and chambers of commerce to support the identified businesses and strengthen the market linkages.

SOUTH-SOUTH AND TRIANGULAR COOPERATION (SSC/TRC)

The project intends to work with countries that will implement the JSB 2021. Along with other country offices, the project will be able to organise "learning and experience sharing" events on the human security approach implemented in Afghanistan. The learning events will be organised in collaboration with UNDP Regional Bureau for Asia & pacific (RBAP), GPN (Global Policy Network) and the DEU (Development Effectiveness Unit). It will also provide excellent opportunities for Afghanistan to learn from other country offices that work in fragile and crisis contexts. The event(s) will explore how to target

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beneficiaries who are being brought onboard through virtual learning processes as a part of South-South cooperation. The project will ensure the equal representation of women and men, encouraging them to share their experience(s), present their achievements, discuss challenges and document success stories and lessons learnt.

KNOWLEDGE MANAGEMENT

The Project's knowledge, good practices and lessons will be captured and assessed regularly by the project team in place-based and thematic orientations. In addition, data actively sourced from other projects and partners will be verified by community teams before being integrated with the planned interventions.The project will develop and disseminate knowledge products for use by the project's beneficiaries (CSOs, private sector organizations, SMEs, youth groups, women's groups etc.) This knowledge will be shared through UNDP publications issued by the project (including UNDP's annual reports, progress reports, sector-specific reports and the quarterly reports of the responsible parties). The lessons learnt and success stories will be shared among the duty-bearer and communities in Afghanistan, including development partners.

SUSTAINABILITY AND SCALING UP

The project will work closely with those service provider agencies covering health, social services, employment training, essential basic services, and those supporting returnees and IDPs or women-specific services, to improve sustainability and provide a scaling-up mechanism. Given the current political system in Afghanistan, the civil society engagement space and the level of civic and community ownership will be strengthened by this project. The project will also collaborate with the Humanitarian Cluster and the Protection Cluster and their partners in scaling-up the efforts where the interventions are linked with IDPs and returnees. The project will facilitate the interface between district-level service providers and community-based institutions to strengthen the referral pathways. Linking livelihood opportunities with protection service providers will ensure the potential to scale-up through the cluster mechanism to support the most vulnerable communities affected by fragility and hostilities. The networking through these clusters will enhance UNDP's "human security" approach for upcoming interventions and help to scale-up any future project(s). Interventions will adopt a value chain approach by promoting and linking together local producers, market actors, private sectors, and economic institutions. The project will strengthen value chains and sustain MSMEs by building horizon and vertical linkages. For example, MSMEs and microbusinesses have a significant advantage over larger organisations in addressing sustainability issues - their size means they can react very quickly to changes in the business environment.

VISIBILITY

Given the current security environment in Afghanistan, UNDP will regularly discuss the project with the Embassy of Japan to balance any security concerns with the need to ensure that the support received from the Government of Japan (GoJ) is as visible as possible and is represented in a mutually acceptable manner in significant activities and advocacy events. For example, UNDP's communication team will include recognition of the support received from the GoJ in all publications and in all printed, electronic and display materials produced by the project, as well ensure that the GoJ's contributions are acknowledged properly in any communications by project partners.

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IV. Project Management

COST EFFICIENCY AND EFFECTIVENESS

The project introduces the following features designed to enhance the effectiveness of its development and reform interventions:

Population Targeting (Leave No One Behind)

Selection of the target populations and beneficiaries informed by the Situation Analysis and Strategic Overview based on the identified risks and vulnerabilities, as well as the specific issues within the area.

Socially inclusive approach

In the planning and implementation of projects and programs, the project will apply integrated approaches that are both socially inclusive and diversity-based to include those left furthest behind.

Cross-Agency Platform Approach

The planned interventions inter-connected and interact with many different SDGs such as Poverty (SDG1), Health (SDG 3), Gender (SDG 5), Reducing Inequalities (SDG 10), Peace, (SDG 16) the project will use a platform approach which will involve wide range of partners, and other stakeholders across many sectors on broader development issues together (such as gender, housing, education, health, and access to income and decent work) to work on these issues. A cross-agency approach will ensure more coordinated programmatic responses.

Harmonised and Integrated Development Approaches

The project will be implemented within a broader programmatic framework, notably encompassing livelihoods, local economic development, social cohesion, conflict resolution, and disaster response, thereby making the stabilization interventions more strategic and effective for the people.

Gender-Inclusive Approaches

Through its stakeholder and beneficiary targeting strategy, the project will involve both women/men, women's NGOs, specialised institutions and civil society groups in order to ensure interventions are gender-sensitive, effective, and contribute to gender-related interventions by which the gender gap will be reduced.

Health & Safety and Environmental Safeguards

The project will analyse and address significant social, environmental, and occupational health and safety risks and impacts via UNDP's Strategic Environmental and Social Assessment (revised SESA, 2021).

Harmonised and Integrated Development Approaches

The project will be implemented within a broader programmatic framework, notably encompassing livelihoods, local economic development, social cohesion, conflict resolution, and disaster response, thereby making the stabilisation interventions more strategic and effective for the people.

Effective project management will be critical, given the project's importance, size and complexity. To this end, the management of the project will be based on a simple and structured yet flexible framework, emphasising measurable outcomes and benefits. The following guiding principles will be applied:

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- **Do No Harm**: This approach ensures that the project's work does not inadvertently fuel conflicts and disrupt peace or negatively impact social cohesion.
- **Conflict Sensitivity approach**: This project has been developed based on a detailed understanding of the local context, has been built on participatory approaches and is flexible enough to adapt to changing contexts.
- **Foster local ownership and skills transfer**: This will be both through the Board members and through the day-to-day involvement of responsible parties and stakeholders.
- **Gender equality**: The project will apply gender-sensitive language, pay careful attention to local social norms, collect and analyse gender-specific data, promote equal access to and use of services, and involve both men and women.

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V. RESULT FRAMEWORK AND WORK PLAN

Year: 2022 and 2023 (1 June 2022 - 31 March 2023)	
CPD	Outcome 3: Economic growth is accelerated to reduce vulnerabilities and poverty, strengthen the resilience of the licit economy and reduce the illicit economy in its multiple dimensions
ABADEI Results	Provision of Access to Essential Services
	Community-Based Livelihoods and Local Economic Activities
	Community Resilience and Social Cohesion
TEF (Transitional Engagement Framework)	Outcome 2: By the end of 2022, essential services are sustained that address basic human needs for the people in Afghanistan
	Outcome 3: By the end of 2022, Afghanistan will preserve social investments and community-level systems essential to meeting basic human needs, protect gains to the SDGs, and develop scenarios for future engagement
Initiation Plan Modality (	UNDP Direct Implementation

Output 1: Community-led and community-owned livelihoods opportunities enhanced to prevent people from adopting negative coping strategies	**Gender Marker**	**GEN2**
Indicators	Baseline (2022)	Annual Target (2022)
1.1 Number of active MSMEs supported to open new production facilities (disaggregated by sex)	0	40 SME 1,000 micro
1.2 Number of SMEs supported with the provision of stand-alone solar electricity for the production facilities (disaggregated by sex)	0	60
1.3 a. Number of communities supported for the identification of local need and the creation of social enterprises or livelihoods	0	40
1.3 b. Number of supply agreements between community participants and existing MSMEs	0	40
1.4 a. Number of people employed through the Cash for Work/Cash for Services Scheme (disaggregated by sex)	0	134,830
1.4.b. Number of basic facilities [10]powered through renewable energy (disaggregated by type of facility)	0	500

PLANNED ACTIVITIES	**Actions / Inputs Description**	**TIMEFRAME**				**RESPONSIBLE PARTY**	**PLANNED BUDGET**		
		2022			2023				
	Associated Actions/Results	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1		Donor	Budget Account and Description	Amount
Activity Result 1.1: Identification of active Micro, Small and Medium-Sized Enterprises (40 MSMEs and 100 micro-businesses) and provision of financial and technical support aimed at business continuation and the opening of smaller production facilities in high poverty areas to create employment opportunities for at-risk population groups	1.1 Financial (equipment) and Technical Support for 40 SMEs 1.2 Financial (equipment) and Technical Support for 1,000 micro-businesses 1.3 Permit fees and operating license costs 1.4 MSP fee 1.5 IP cost (Contractor) 1.6 Third party monitoring 1.7 Provision of PPE cost	x	x	x	x	UNDP	Japan	72100 Contractual services – Companies	$2,982,080

[10] Basic facilities are inked to food security, water, transport, health and market linkages etc.

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Activity Result 1.2: Identification and solarization of production facilities of 60 selected SMEs, calculation	2.1 Provision of Solar Electricity for 60 MSMEs 2.2 Permit fees and operating license costs 2.3 MSP fee 2.4 IP cost (Contractor)	x	x	x	x	UNDP	Japan	72100 Contractual services – Companies	$1,161,000
Activity Result 1.3: Identification of communities and provision of financial and technical support to assist with the identification of local needs and the creation of 30 social enterprises (micro-businesses) in areas (10 SE x 4 province) such as food security, health, renewable energy, waste management, clean water access, and education. The identified microbusinesses will receive COVID-19 awareness and PPE (mask, gloves and sanitizer)	3.1 Support creation of 40 social enterprises 3.2 Provision of Renewable Energy 3.3 Permit fees and operating license costs 3.4 MSP fee 3.5 IP cost (Contractor) 3.6 Provision of PPE cost 3.7 Third party monitoring	x	x	x	x	UNDP	Japan	72100 Contractual services – Companies	$2,455,772
Activity Result 1.4: Identification of local level needs and creation of employment opportunities through Cash for Work (CFW) schemes aimed at building, rehabilitating, managing, and maintaining small productive infrastructure linked to food security, water access, transport and market linkages, and energy, while providing COVID-19 preventive support (mask and sanitizer)	4.1 Cash for Work Activities 4.2 Provision of Solar Energy Infrastructure (micro-grid) 4.3 Permit fees and operating license costs 4.4 MSP fee 4.5 Implementing Partner (Contractor) 4.6 Provision of PPE cost 4.7 Third party monitoring	x	x	x	x	UNDP	Japan	72100 Contractual services – Companies	$10,164,131
Subtotal Output 1									**$16,762,983**

Output 2: Adolescent youth and children safeguarded from negative influence of crime and violence through the payment of teachers' stipends	**Gender Marker**	**GEN2**
Indicators	Baseline (2022)	Annual Target (2022)
2.1 Scope and nature of payments for teachers' stipend identified[11].	No	Yes
2.2 Number of teachers in primary/tertiary/secondary education paid (disaggregated by sex and education level)	0	194,000 (month)
2.3 Number of payments verified through third party monitoring services.	0	N/A
2.4 Number of schools provided with COVID-19 awareness-raising sessions and pandemic informative materials	0	60

PLANNED ACTIVITIES	**Actions / Inputs Description**	**TIMEFRAME**		**RESPONSIBLE**	**PLANNED BUDGET**
		2022	2023		

[11] Number of teachers who will receive the stipend will be determined through this result which will serve as the revised target for indictaor 2.2

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	Associated Actions/Results	Q 2	Q 3	Q 4	Q1	**PART Y**	Don or	Budget Account and Description	Amount
Activity Result 2.1: Determine the scope and nature of the payment for teachers' stipend in coordination with UNICEF/ARTF (Non-monetary activity - As per UNICEF's systems and procedures)		x	x	x	x	UNICEF	Japan		$0
Activity Result 2.2: Provide stipend to target public teachers	2.1 Payments to all school-based staff in public primary and secondary schools 2.2 Humanitarian cash Operations and Programme Ecosystem (HOPE) costs 2.3 Fees to bank transfers and money service providers (cash in hand) 2.4 Payment verification – Rapid Pro (mobile SMS) 2.5 Grievance and accountability mechanisms 2.6 Direct monitoring, supervision, technical support - via education and Project Management Unit (PMU) staffing 2.7 Direct operational support costs to ensure efficient and effective implementation: The contribution to direct programme support costs is used to cover funding gaps for provision of security; cross sectoral costs, support staff from operations, information, and communication; field office and maintenance; vehicle running and maintenance costs; travel; electricity and water; office supplies and consumables; cost-sharing for the UN common services; and other such provisions	x	x	x	x	UNICEF	Japan	72100 Contractual services – Companies	$21,586,667
Activity Result 2.3: Ensure with UNICEF that payments are verified through a third-party monitor-Third party monitoring contract		x	x	x	x	UNICEF	Japan	72100 Contractual services – Companies	$1,700,000
Activity Result 2.4: Carry out awareness-raising in 60 schools on COVID-19 and support 60 schools with COVID-19 containment materials	4.1 Grants 4.2 Awareness training 4.3 Professional fees 4.4 Monitoring 4.5 Procurement of COVID-19 prevention items					UNICEF	Japan	72100 Contractual services – Companies	$500,000
Indirect Costs						UNICEF	Japan		$1,713,333
Subtotal Output 2									**$ 25,500,000**

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Output 3: Community safety and security strengthened through community engagement and empowerment to build trust and confidence									**Gender Marker**	**GEN2**
Indicators									Baseline (2022)	Annual Target (2022)
3.1 Number of community-led security plans formulated									0	4 (1 per province)
3.2 a. Number of community targeted social and trust building dialogue sessions conducted through offline and virtual/online medium									0	1
3.2 b. Number of neighbourhood security committee supported for social cohesion activities									0	16
3.3 Number people reached through community social dialogues/advocacy (disaggregated by sex) [12]									0	24,000
PLANNED ACTIVITIES	**Actions / Inputs Description**	**TIMEFRAME**				**RESPONSIBLE PARTY**	**PLANNED BUDGET**			
		2022			2023					
	Associated Actions/Results	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1		Donor	Budget Account and Description		Amount
Activity Result 3.1: Provide grants to CSOs to formulate community-led plans and initiatives for community security monitoring, reporting and early response	1.1 Low-value grants for 10 CSOs per province x 4 provinces (training and security plans and awareness raising) 1.2 Transport allowance, monitoring support for 40 CSOs 1.3 Purchase basic items for monitoring and reporting for community (flashlights, seasonal boots, jackets etc.) for 40 communities	x	x	x	x	UNDP	Japan	72100 Contractual services – Companies		$2,300,000
Activity Result 3.2: Support communities, networks particularly women and youth committees to disrupt processes of radicalization and promote rights-based narratives, tolerance and respect for diversity using online/virtual tools and off-line social dialogues	2.1 Formulating community security neighborhood committees with a certain % youth groups, women, religious leaders and conflict resolution mechanism audio visual publications, network set up, training and monitoring human rights-based narratives 2.2 Network set up, training and monitoring human rights-based narratives) 2.3 Audio visual publications 2.4 Virtual/online tool and targeted actions designed (in Dari and Pashto language) using the CSOs and 20 offline social dialogues on security issues with the communities identified by CSOs and app/online tool development by CS	x	x	x	x	UNDP	Japan	72100 Contractual services – Companies 72400 - Communic & Audio Visual Equip		$620,000
Subtotal Output 3										**$2,920,000**

[12] 16 committees reach out to 250 people per month over a six-month period (250*6 months=1,500*16 committees=24,000)

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PLANNED ACTIVITIES	Actions / Inputs Description	TIMEFRAME				RESPONSIBLE PARTY	PLANNED BUDGET		
		2022			2023				
	Associated Actions/Results	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1		Donor	Budget Account and Description	Amount
Project Management **Communication** **M&E** **DPC** **Overhead**	Project staff Project Manager	x	x	x	x	UNDP	Japan	61300 - Salary & Post Adj Cst-IP Staff 71400 - Contractual Services - Individ	$2,222,012
	Communication and Visibility	x	x	x	x	UNDP	Japan		$100,000
	Monitoring &Evaluation and Final Evaluation	x	x	x	x	UNDP	Japan		$100,000
	DPC	x	x	x	x	UNDP	Japan	73100 - Rental & Maintenance-Premises 74500 - Miscellaneous Expenses	$1,700,516
	GMS 8%	x	x	x	x	UNDP	Japan	75100 - Facilities & Administration	$3,944,281
Subtotal									**$8,064,809**

Grand Total	**$53,247,792**

V I: MONITORING AND EVALUATION

In accordance with UNDP's programming policies and procedures, the project will be monitored through the following monitoring and evaluation plans: *[Note: monitoring and evaluation plans should be adapted to project context, as needed.*

Monitoring Activity	Purpose	Frequency	Expected Action	Partners (if joint)	Cost (if any)
Track results progress	Progress data against the results indicators in the project will be collected and analyzed to assess the progress of the project in achieving the agreed outputs.	Quarterly, or in the frequency required for	Slower than expected progress will be addressed by project management.	UNDP	

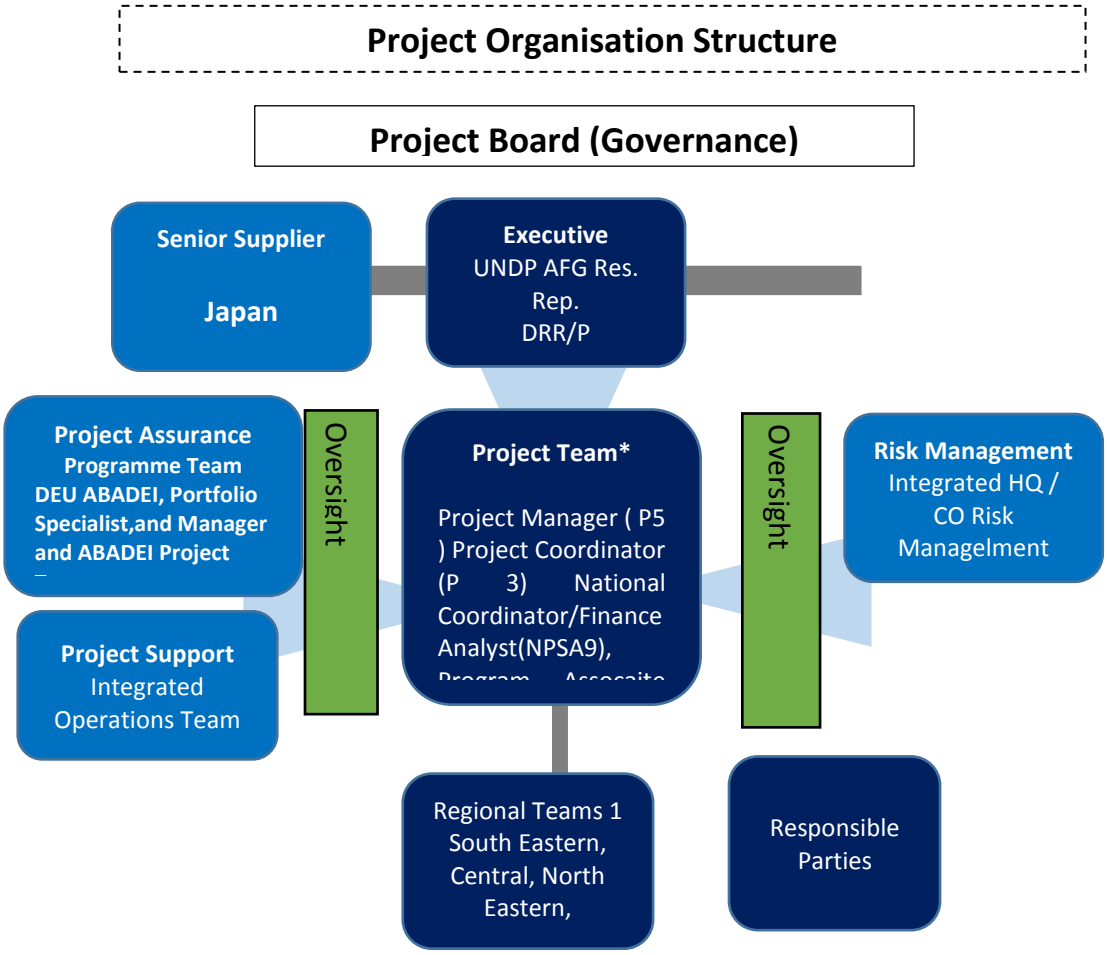
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Monitoring Activity	Purpose	Frequency	Expected Action	Partners (if joint)	Cost (if any)
		each indicator.			
Monitor and Manage Risk	Identify specific risks that may threaten achievement of intended results. Identify and monitor risk management actions using a risk log. This includes monitoring measures and plans that may have been required as per UNDP's Social and Environmental Standards. Audits will be conducted in accordance with UNDP's audit policy to manage financial risk.	Quarterly	Risks are identified by project management and actions are taken to manage risk. The risk log is actively maintained to keep track of identified risks and actions taken.	UNDP	
Learn	Knowledge, good practices and lessons will be captured regularly, as well as actively sourced from other projects and partners and integrated back into the project.	At least annually	Relevant lessons are captured by the project team and used to inform management decisions.	UNDP	
Annual Project Quality Assurance	The quality of the project will be assessed against UNDP's quality standards to identify project strengths and weaknesses and to inform management decision making to improve the project.	Annually	Areas of strength and weakness will be reviewed by project management and used to inform decisions to improve project performance.	UNDP	
Review and Make Course Corrections	Internal review of data and evidence from all monitoring actions to inform decision making.	At least annually	Performance data, risks, lessons and quality will be discussed by the project board and used to make course corrections.	UNDP	
Project Report	A progress report will be presented to the Project Board and key stakeholders, consisting of progress data showing the results achieved against pre-defined annual targets at the output level, the annual project quality rating summary, an updated risk long with mitigation measures, and any evaluation or review reports prepared over the period.	Annually, and at the end of the project (final report)	Capture key progress results and impact to present to key stakeholders with the support of an reporting and editorial expert.	UNDP	
Project Review (Project Board)	The project's governance mechanism (i.e., project board) will hold regular project reviews to assess the performance of the project and review the Multi-Year Work Plan to ensure realistic budgeting over the life of the project. In the project's final year, the Project Board shall hold an end-of project review to capture lessons learned and discuss opportunities for scaling up and to socialize project results and lessons learned with relevant audiences.	Specify frequency (i.e., at least annually)	Any quality concerns or slower than expected progress should be discussed by the project board and management actions agreed to address the issues identified.	UNDP	

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VII. Management Arrangement

The Initiation Plan will be directly implemented by UNDP. The ABADEI Project Governance Structure will provide guidance and direction to the Project Team and the ABADEI Project Board will serve as an oversight mechanism.



The Project will be implemented by the UNDP, four Regional Offices in South Eastern, Central, North Eastern, and Southern under the direct implementation modality (DIM). The established project team will be expanded to implement the activities under the management structure described in Table 1 (above).

A Project Board will be set up under the project to provide an oversight mechanism. This Board will have the following roles:

1) **Chair:** The UNDP Resident Representative/Deputy Resident Representative (Programme) of the Afghanistan Country Office will chair the Board to provide ownership.

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2) **Senior Suppliers:** individuals or groups representing the interests of all parties concerned will provide funding and/or technical expertise as well as help to facilitate the necessary UNDP approvals for implementing the portfolio. The Senior Suppliers' primary function within the Board is to assess the technical feasibility of proposed interventions and to help obtain the necessary approvals. The composition of the Senior Suppliers group and the level of authority required to ensure a quick and efficient response using the non-standard or non-traditional methods of operation warranted in the current context of Afghanistan.

3) **Project Assurance office (DEU and PMU): The Project Board** will be supported by a Project Assurance office (Development Effectiveness Unit and Programme Management Unit) who work independently of the project manager to ensure objective and independent oversight. This person will ensure that the necessary management approvals are obtained, and that implementation is in accordance with the relevant operational policy and procedures. In addition, they will also support monitoring of the progress of the entire Initiation Plan. The DEU will also provide effective liaison and facilitation to ensure the necessary guidance on policies and procedures is followed by the CO,). Lastly, the unit will also provide ensure that the documentation produced by the project team complies with the necessary quality assurance standards and carry out any other assurance functions entrusted to them by the Project Board.

Project Manager and team: will be involved with overall and day-to-day project delivery planning, managing procurement and recruitment processes and agreements with responsible parties, coordinating with local counterparts and development partners, providing guidance to responsible parties and overseeing their performance, collating and analysing, monitoring data, and preparing progress reports. The Project Manager (P5) level is cost shared with JSB 2021. The overall Project Coordination Specialist (P3). The project will also be supported by ABADEI Programme Management Team, including Project Management Specialist and ABADEI Program Manager its Programme Officer, on a cost-sharing basis.

VISIBILITY OF JAPAN

- UNDP will regularly discuss the project with the Government of Japan to balance the visibility of support received from the Government of Japan with the security concerns, considering the current security environment of Afghanistan.
- UNDP will provide recognition to the donor in all printed and display materials and Flagship publications.
- UNDP will consult with the Government of Japan to better understand immediate visibility needs and opportunities in major activities and advocacy events of UNDP.
- UNDP is committed to ensuring the visibility of Japan's support of this project through UNDP's communication team.

REPORTING

Reports on the contributions made by the Government of Japan will be after three months the project end, including final narrative and financial reports.

VIII. LEGAL CONTEXT

Option b. Where the country has NOT signed the Standard Basic Assistance Agreement (SBAA)

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The project document shall be the instrument envisaged and defined in the Supplemental Provisions to the Project Document, attached hereto and forming an integral part hereof, as "the Project Document".

This project will be implemented by [name of entity] ("Implementing Partner") in accordance with its financial regulations, rules, practices and procedures only to the extent that they do not contravene the principles of the Financial Regulations and Rules of UNDP. Where the financial governance of an Implementing Partner does not provide the required guidance to ensure best value for money, fairness, integrity, transparency, and effective international competition, the financial governance of UNDP shall apply.

IX. RISK MANAGEMENT

*[NOTE: Please choose **one** of the following options that corresponds to the implementation modality of the Project. Delete all other options.]*

Option b. UNDP (DIM)

UNDP as the Implementing Partner will comply with the policies, procedures and practices of the United Nations Security Management System (UNSMS.)

RISK REGISTER

#	Description	Risk Category	Impact & Likelihood = Risk Level	Risk Treatment/ Management Measures	Risk Owner
1	Compromised local staff security	Safety and Security	Local staff is subjected to persecution by the *de facto* administration. P=2.75 I=3 Risk level=Moderate	Through the collaborative efforts under UNCT, CO with de-facto administration will advocate about UNDP programme, type of interventions, and protection of IPs and UNDP local / international staff (including female colleagues). Regular communication protocol and hotline with authorities at local, regional and central level will be maintained. The security and conflict situation will be continuously monitored, with (at least) monthly review of operating modalities. This will be done in close collaboration with UNAMA and UNCT.	CO CO CO
2	Compromised international staff security	Safety and security	Security of international staff is compromised during the implementation of a growing portfolio. P = 2.25 I = 3 Risk	Through the collaborative efforts under UNCT, CO with de-facto administration will advocate about UNDP programme, type of interventions, and protection of IPs and UNDP local / international staff (including female colleagues). Regular communication protocol and hotline with authorities at local, regional and central level will be maintained.	CO CO CO

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			level=Moderate	The security and conflict situation will be continuously monitored, with (at least) monthly review of operating modalities. This will be done in close collaboration with UNAMA and UNCT.	
3	Compromised IP and beneficiary security	Safety and Security	UNDP interventions put the lives of implementing partners and beneficiaries at risk P = 2.75 I = 3 Risk level=Moderate	Through the collaborative efforts under UNCT, CO with de-facto administration will advocate about UNDP programme, type of interventions, and protection of IPs and UNDP local / international staff (including female colleagues). Regular communication protocol and hotline with authorities at local, regional and central level will be maintained. The security and conflict situation will be continuously monitored, with (at least) monthly review of operating modalities. This will be done in close collaboration with UNAMA and UNCT.	CO CO CO
4	Lack of Access to the target beneficiaries	Programmatic	UNDP interventions cannot reach those most in need, especially women, girls and youth. P = 2.25 I = 2 Risk level=Low	A continuous "dynamic impact, conflict & risk monitoring capacity" and adaptive management processes will be established that will help identify the people most in need and prioritize related interventions. Regular communication protocol and hotline with authorities at local, regional and central level will be maintained. The CO will also engage in gradual confidence building and discuss sensitive topics (e.g. women's participation in economy).	CO CO CO
6	Programme politicisation	Reputational	Programme interventions are politicized and used to support local and central political forces. P = 3 I = 2 Risk level=Low	Communications that demonstrate transparency and pre-empts misperceptions and ill-founded accusations will be proactively and corporately will be supported. Crisis communication team will be put in place to address any potential politization and use of programme interventions by local and central political forces. A data-driven mechanism that will guide targeting and allocations (ref Yemen: "Distress Index") will be established.	CO CO CO

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7	Programme perceived to do harm	Reputational	International accusations that UNDP support leads to human rights violations and conflict. P = 2.25 I = 2 Risk level=Low	Communications that demonstrates transparency and pre-empts misperceptions and ill-founded accusations will be proactively and corporately supported. A data-driven mechanism that will guide targeting and allocations (ref Yemen: "Distress Index") will be established. Activities which have the potential to capacitate or trigger human rights violations will be excluded. CSOs and IPs will be trained on the do-no-harm approach.	CO CO CO CO
8	UNDP positioning failures	Partnerships	Inability to position UNDP as critical actor that can positively impact the lives of communities in need. P = 2.25 I = 2 Risk level=Low	Communications that demonstrate transparency and pre-empts misperceptions and ill-founded accusations will be proactively and corporately supported. A data-driven mechanism that will guide targeting and allocations (ref Yemen: "Distress Index") will be established, reflecting UNDP's capacity to identify and address the needs of most in need.	CO CO
9	Humanitarian - recovery conflict	Coordination	UNDP interventions compromise humanitarian operations P = 1 I = 2 Risk level=Low	Regular communication, coordination, and joint planning will be conducted with international and local organizations from the humanitarian sector. A continuous "dynamic impact, conflict & risk monitoring capacity" and adaptive management processes will be established to prevent and tackle any potential impact on humanitarian operations.	CO CO
10	High levels of corruption	Fiduciary	UNDP programmes are subject to significant levels of corruption and embezzlement. P = 3 I = 2 Risk level=Low	A fiduciary risk management package including targeted beneficiary and RP surveys and training will be established, as well as a 24/7 AC whistle blower hotline and channel. IPs / RPs and UNDP transactions will be continuously audited. A vendor prequalification exercise will be immediately launched and continuously updated.	CO CO CO

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				A private sector company will be hired to run background checks on potential vendors in key areas. The CO will carefully experiment with funds transfer modalities including direct transaction management, reimbursements and limited funds transfers. Fiduciary capacities as key offer to public administration at local, regional and central levels will be developed.	CO CO
11	Sanctions related financial bottlenecks	Operational	International sanctions prevent CO from access to required financial resources. P = 1.75 I = 2 Risk level=Low	Strong partnerships and regular communications with donors will be maintained. UNDP's reputation as a key actor on the ground able to deliver in an effective, sustainable and transparent manner will be strengthened. Alternative financing sources may be considered (e.g. private funding), provided that they are in line with the UN values and UNDP's mission in the country.	CO CO
12	Capacity failure	Operational	Inability to scale up CO capacities in order to implement a rapidly growing portfolio. P = 2.5 I = 3 Risk level=Moderate	A CO capacity and prospective workload analysis will be conducted.	CO
13	Humanitarian - recovery conflict	Coordination	UNDP interventions compromise humanitarian operations P = 1 I = 2 Risk level=Low	• Regular communication, coordination, and joint planning will be conducted with international and local organizations from the humanitarian sector. • A continuous "dynamic impact, conflict & risk monitoring capacity" and adaptive management processes will be established to prevent and tackle any potential impact on humanitarian operations.	CO

Risks	**Explanation**

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Political risks	The UN works within complex dynamics reflecting competing interests of geopolitical actors and member states, which may limit the response to the scale of needs of a society under economic pressure and trauma, and security and access constraints. The UN maintains its operational and political integrity through adherence to the principles of impartiality, independence, human rights and inclusive humanitarian/development assistance, and engages stakeholders in communicating these principles. UNDP coordinates with the United Nations Assistance Mission in Afghanistan (UNAMA) and the UN Special Political Mission, and is a member of the Humanitarian Country Team and the UN Country Team to address political risks collectively.
Operational risks	Due to the ongoing COVID-19 pandemic and the now wide-spread Omicron variant, conflict over scarce resources and related insecurity, the existence of paramilitary groups and ISIL-K (Islamic State in Iraq and the Levant-Khorasan) in Afghanistan, the project is likely to face potential disruption in UNDP's business processes and the delivery of its project management services. UNDP has developed a Business Continuity Plan (BCP) for COVID-19, ensuring that critical office functions can be performed from other locations if necessary. UNDP has a presence in eight regions through its ongoing ABADEI programs. It is recommended that implementing partners take preventive measures for their frontline staff as well as for beneficiaries to mitigate the risks of COVID-19 infection.
Financial/fiduciary risks	The financial and fiduciary risks include hyper-inflation, fraud, money laundering and cash advance management. UNDP's anti-fraud policy, the annual audits, regular spot-checking by UNDP staff, the HACT procedure, the stringent vetting procedure for implementing partners, third party money transfer mechanisms and the donor's own internal procedures to mitigate the risk of fraud, misappropriation, and diversion of funds.
Programmatic risks	The programmatic risks are associated with access to and targeting of beneficiaries due to security-related obstacles, although these obstacles can be mitigated by involving UNDP's partnership network. UNDP is potential unable to verify results on the ground directly, recruit staff in a timely fashion to support project implementation and can expect delays in meet delivery targets. Empowering women and promoting gender equality in the context of Shariya law and level of power within the targeted communities may lead to GBV or other risks. Male/female community committees established throughout the project can be used to create awareness of women's human rights, GBV and PSEA and how to respond and report to such incidents. The risk mitigation units established under UNDP will assess potential risks and establish accountability channels to mitigate the probability of such incidents. Also, given the current context of Afghanistan, a Maharam (male companion) system will be established to support women-led businesses and work on women's engagement. Taking all these factors into account, UNDP will closely review the quarterly expenditure and progress reports of the responsible parties to monitor the financial delivery of the project. These interventions will be applied with a robust conflict sensitivity and 'do no harm' lens to ensure that women beneficiaries of the project interventions are not subject to further risks and potential harm.
Security risks	The ongoing crisis situation and fragility continue to pose significant security risks to implementing the project in the form of (petty) crime, terrorist attacks, bombings, explosions, kidnapping, ransom, summary executions, and arbitrary arrests and detentions. This situation was compounded by the breakdown of law and order and the rise of crime and general insecurity. UNDP intends to mitigate these risks through close collaboration and coordination with the UN Department for Safety and Security, including

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	the de-facto government protocols and strict adherence to UN security procedures. Staff training in conflict-sensitive communications and risk management will continue.
Social and environmental risks	The project will assess and mitigate any significant social and environmental, and occupational health and safety risks and impacts. Potentially adverse gender and social impacts related to project activities should be identified and measures introduced to reduce gender-based violence, gender-based discrimination, disability, sexual exploitation and the abuse of men, women, girls and boys. Potential risks to full participation and stakeholder engagement will be addressed by UNDP's Stakeholder Engagement (SE), Stakeholder Response Mechanism (SRM) with formal and confidential Complaints Handling Mechanism (CHM). To apply the required mitigation measures, environmental and occupational health and safety risks will be identified and screened according to their perceived risk level low, moderate, substantial, and high.

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PRE-CONDITIONS

- Political/civic space to operate
- Communities are willing to contribute
- Human Rights and Women's Rights are respected
- Partnerships exist for facilitating the desired change
- Finance and Human Resource Capacity
- Market remained open and support MSMEs to strengthen value chain
- Humanitarian and development, peace (HDP) nexus exist and active

Strengthening Community Safety Well-being and Human Security in Afghanistan

Economic growth is accelerated to reduce vulnerabilities and poverty, strengthen the resilience of the licit economy and reduce the illicit economy in its multiple dimensions

LONG-TERM OUTCOMES

OUTPUTS

Enhancing community-led and community-owned economic opportunities and employment prospects

supporting the payment of teachers' stipends to safeguard adolescent youth and children from negative influence of crime and violence.

community safety and security strengthened through community engagement and empowerment to build trust and confidence

Micro, Small and Medium enterprises, COVID-19 preventive support through provision of personal protective equipment (PPE); solar energy support for production, creation of social enterprises and supply agreements and Cash for Work/Cash for Services Scheme

teachers' stipend and Number of schools targeted for COVID-19 awareness-raising and provided with pandemic containing materials containing materials

community-led security plans, virtual/online tools/portals and community social dialogues/advocacy

Assumptions

- Communities and private sector and other actors are willing to adopt new technology and approaches
- Infrastructure work is sufficiently resilient to extreme weather events
- The people of Afghanistan are open to change in their behaviour and to adopting environmentally sustainable practices and social cohesion
- Security conditions will be conducive to programme implementation, particularly in remote and isolated areas.
- All communities & voices are equal

Issues: Absence of social protection and safety nets, COVID-19,Cultural barriers and existing gender inequalities, Distrust, ethnic and tribal divisions, Emerging food security, Gender based violence rights violation, Gender gap in governance and decision making, High number of internally displaced people (IDPs), Issues with damaging roads, sub-roads, irrigation systems, Labour market challe economic and livelihoods opportunities , Lack of access to education, healthcare, employment, economic freedom, Lack of computer and technical skills, and job-oriented skills, Lack of social cohe social mobility, Limited or no access to finance, markets, and raw materials, Low rates of literacy, Lower female literacy rate , Potential conflict drivers, Rapidly increasing poverty, Severe economi Social tensions between communities, Tensions between ethnoreligious and/or tribal communities, The impacts of drought, Uncertainty, fragility, social instability , Unemployment, Unfolding human Weak legal system